

Vancouver City FC: 2025 Strategy

*“Vancouver City’s fan growth has stalled and begun to decline. Prior to the pandemic international supporters **used to make up roughly 40%** of the entire fanbase, but now attendance has started to slip...”*

*“...Overall earnings have **fallen from roughly \$60 million** in prior years to materially lower levels Today.”*

*“...Matchday turnout and in-stadium spending are falling, online sales are **down by 30%** compared to prior seasons, and global engagement remains underdeveloped.”*

Change has long been overdue.

Vancouver City FC (VCFC)

Mission

To inspire passion, pride, and unity through football, on and off the pitch.

Vancouver City FC strives to deliver unforgettable matchday experiences, meaningful community engagement, and innovative global outreach. The club's mission is to grow the game, empower fans, and strengthen connections between players, supporters, and the city it represents.

Values

Community & Belonging



Excellence & Player Pathways



Innovation & Growth



Teamwork & Respect



Data Analysis: Overview

Ingestion: Reading files

Cleaning: Handling nulls and duplicates

Visualization: Time-series + Aggregation

Analysis: Extract insights.

Statistical tests: Verify insights.

Key Issues

Loyalty Incentives

VCFC's special offerings (student section, family bundles, etc.) are broad and surface-level, especially for season pass and premium tickets.

Marketing Misalignment

VCFC's Marketing/PR campaigns fail to generate consistent demand and target key demographics.

Operational Inefficiencies

Stadium operations incur significant losses and can be optimized, especially during off-season.

Issue 1: Loyalty Incentives

"Without targeted campaigns or community-driven content to keep these fans engaged year-round, interest tends to wane until major events or playoff pushes reignite attention"

"fans perceive diminishing value in the overall experience"

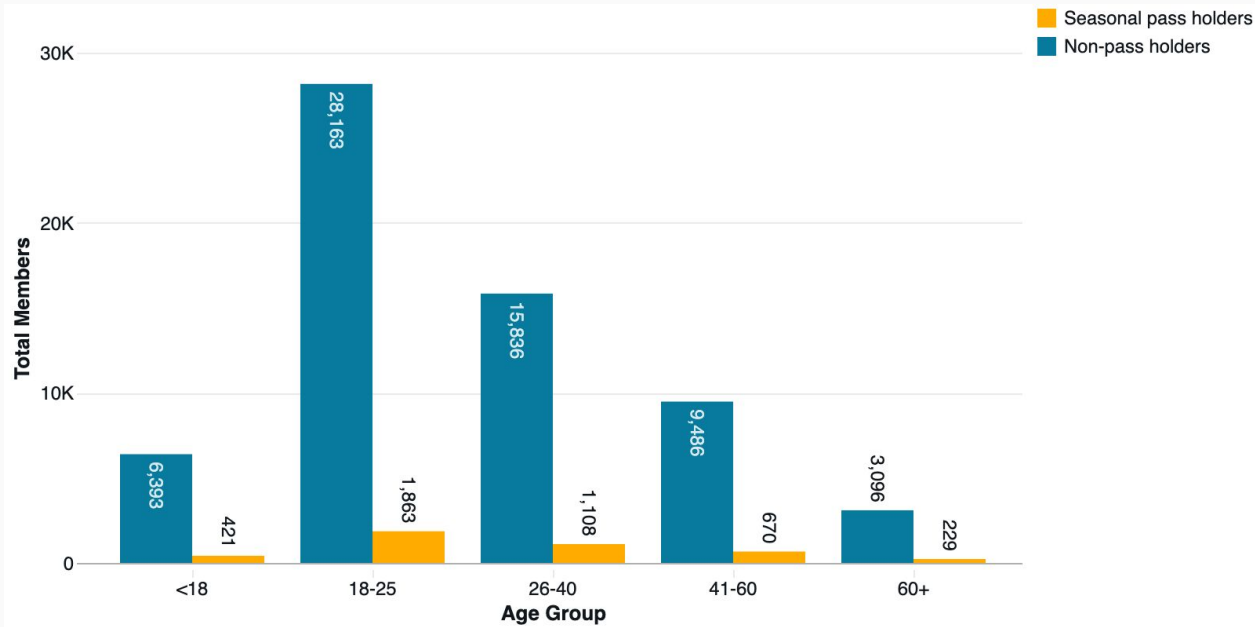
"Competing entertainment options"



Lower fanbase retention. Lower seasonal pass sales = less revenue

Issue 1: Loyalty Incentives

Domestic Seasonal Pass Holders vs Non Seasonal Pass Holders by Age Group

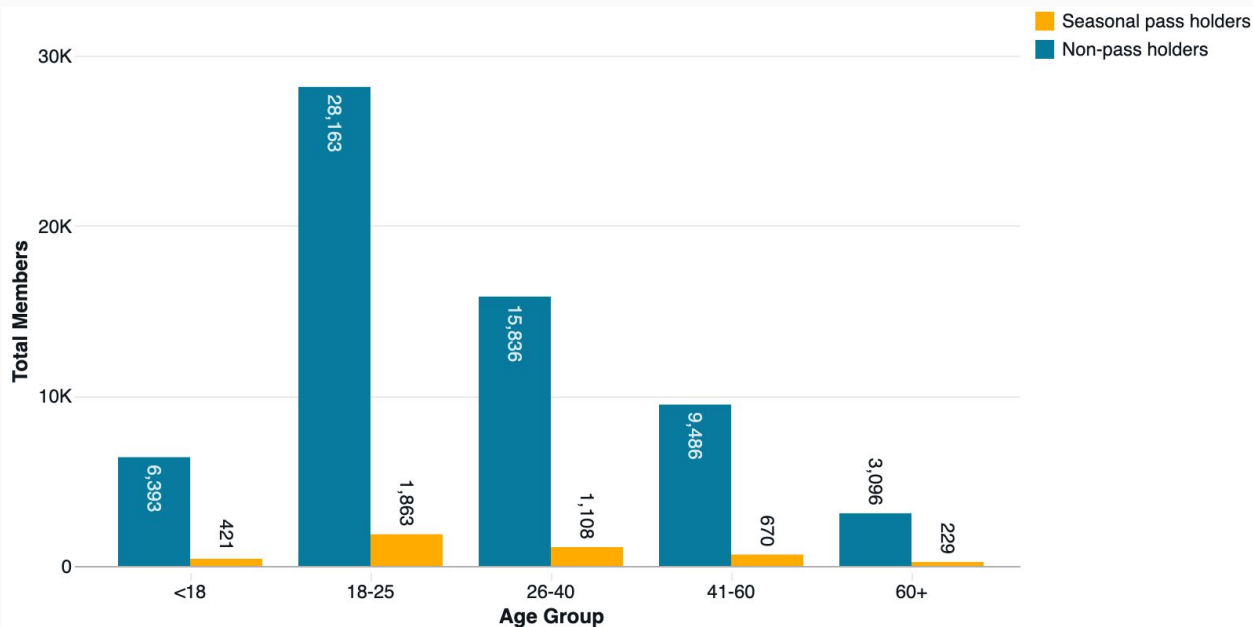


<7%

Hold a seasonal pass
across all age groups in
the **domestic market**

Issue 1: Loyalty Incentives

Domestic Seasonal Pass Holders vs Non Seasonal Pass Holders by Age Group



<7%

Hold a seasonal pass across all age groups in the **domestic market**

Relative to stadium capacity, the proportion of season pass holders

Seattle Sounders	~ 44%
LAFC	~ 77%
VCFC	< 8%

Club Memberships and Points-based Offers

Loyal VCFC members could earn membership points by attending games.

- Contribute to premium ticket/seasonal pass purchases.
- Exchange for merchandise
- Other exclusive offers

Tailor Seasonal Pass Benefits by Age Group

70% of fans are ages 18-40.

Tailor benefits to parents with young children.

- Exclusive meet and greets
- Football lessons
- Cheaper youth tickets

Tailor benefits across generations

- Cheaper senior tickets

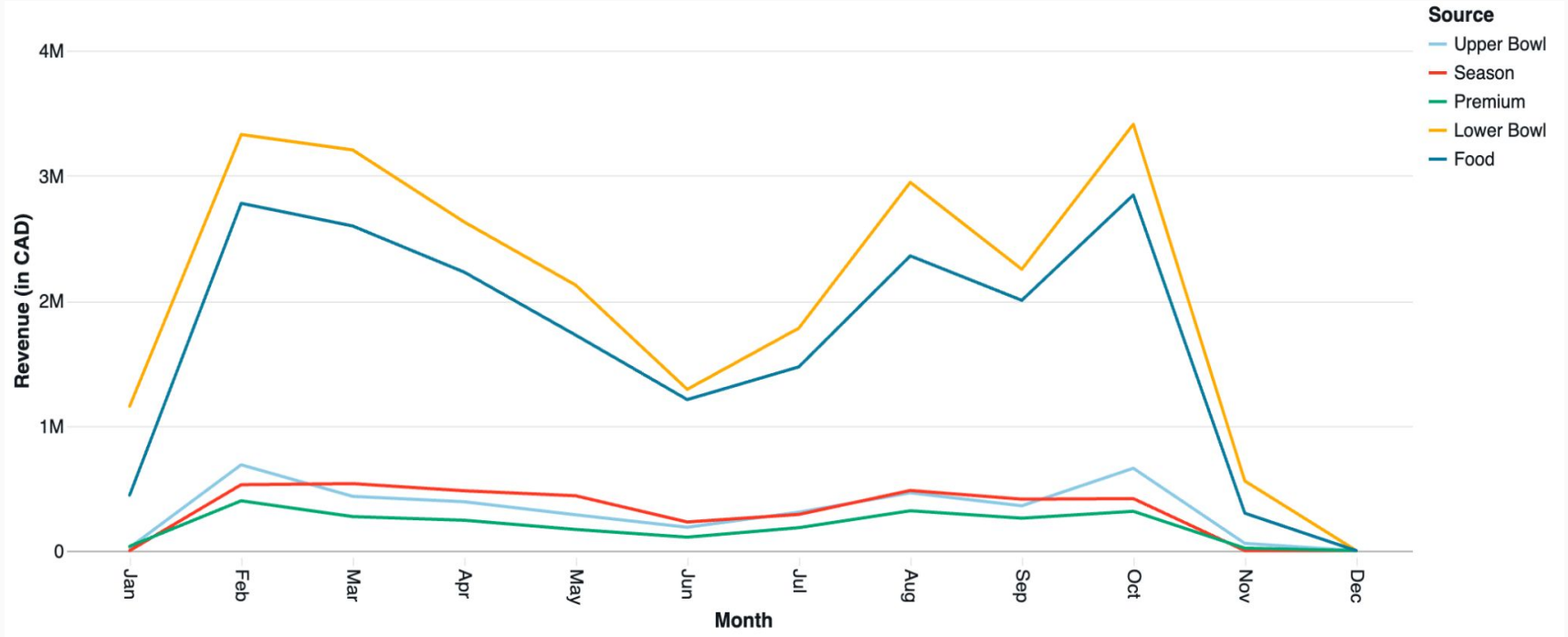


Increased demand for seasonal pass domestically.

+

Increased longevity of domestic fanbase loyalty.

Monthly Revenue (2024)



Upper Bowl, Lower Bowl, and Food Revenue follows Seasonal and Premium pass (Spearman $\rho > 0.8$)

Risk Assessment

Risk	Rationale	Mitigation
Reduced Global Reach	By tailoring offers to domestic fans, international fans lose out.	Short-term solution to boost community-led marketing campaigns via social media, potential for global reach. Expand benefits (flight packages, hotels, etc.) to international fans in the long run.
Reduced Global Revenue		Targeting online merchandise sales to international fans (explained later in the presentation). Approx. 90% of fans are domestic.
Fairness	Seasonal pass holders are perceived as superior.	Points-based club membership bridges this gap by allowing general fans to accrue similar benefits.

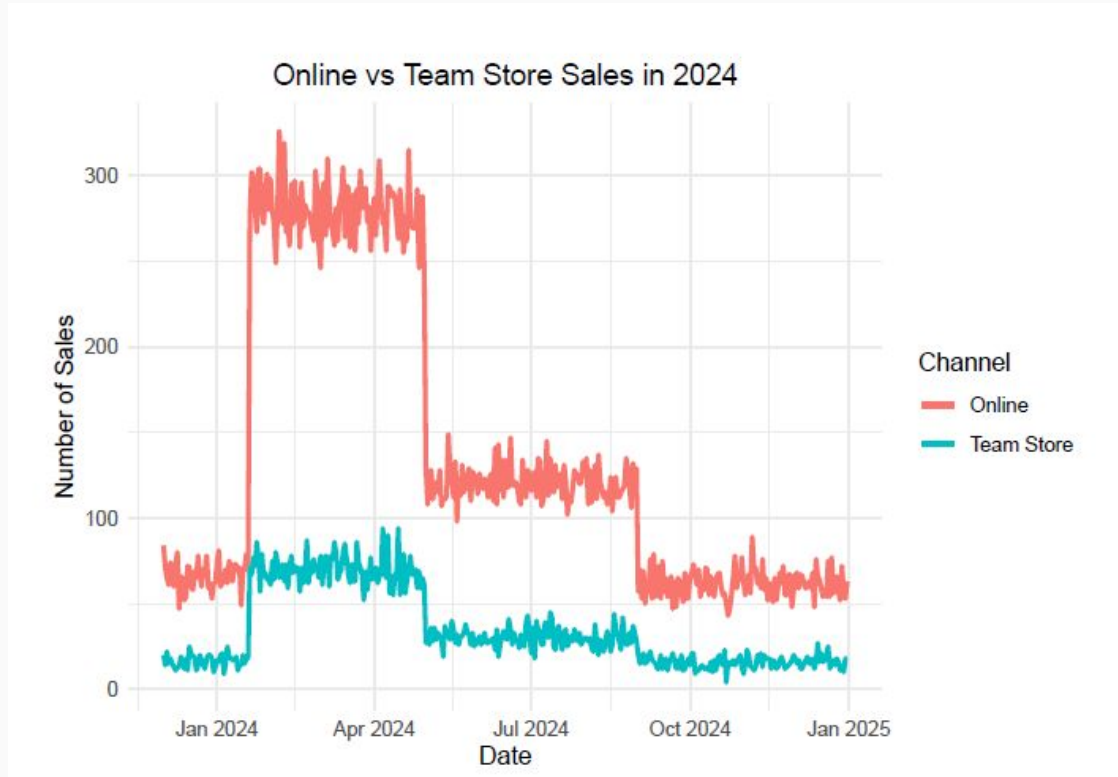
KPIs:

- Proportion of seasonal pass sales
- Number of domestic fans in the 18 - 25 and 26 - 40 age group

Outcome:

- Revitalize and strengthen local football community.
- Global growth through domestic community-led marketing.

Issue 2: Marketing Misalignment



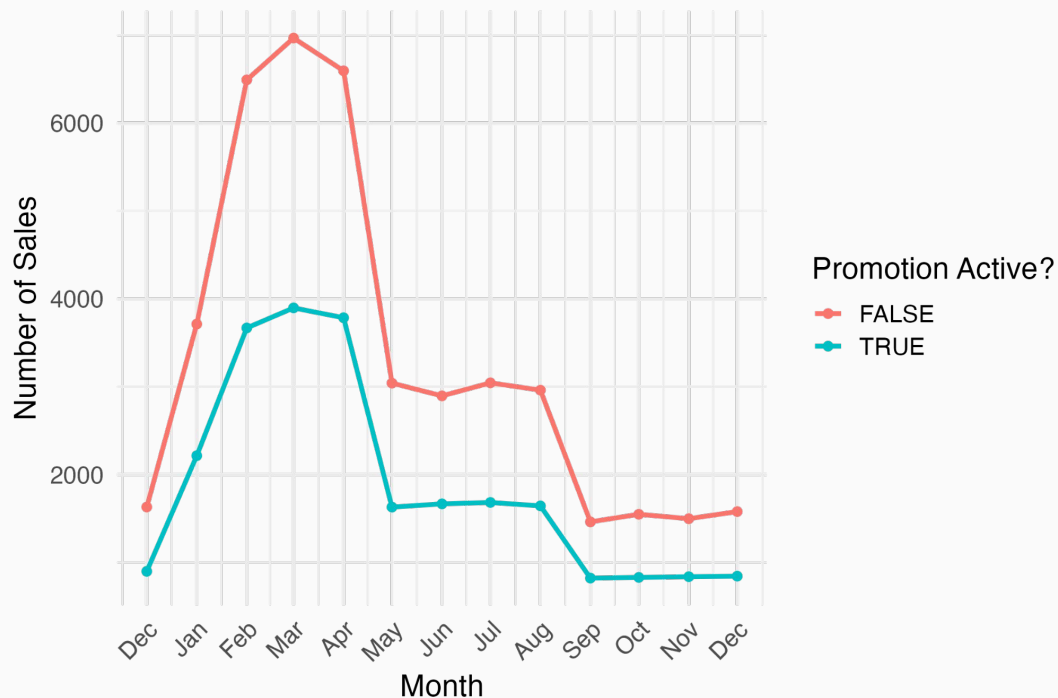
From April to May,
merchandise sales
across all channels drop

55%

Issue 2: Marketing Misalignment

Monthly Sales With vs Without Promotion

Comparing promotional impact on sales volume



Promotions have a flat impact on sales. (Current promotions aren't working)

Product Analytics

Youth are underbuying accessory products like posters, mugs, and caps.

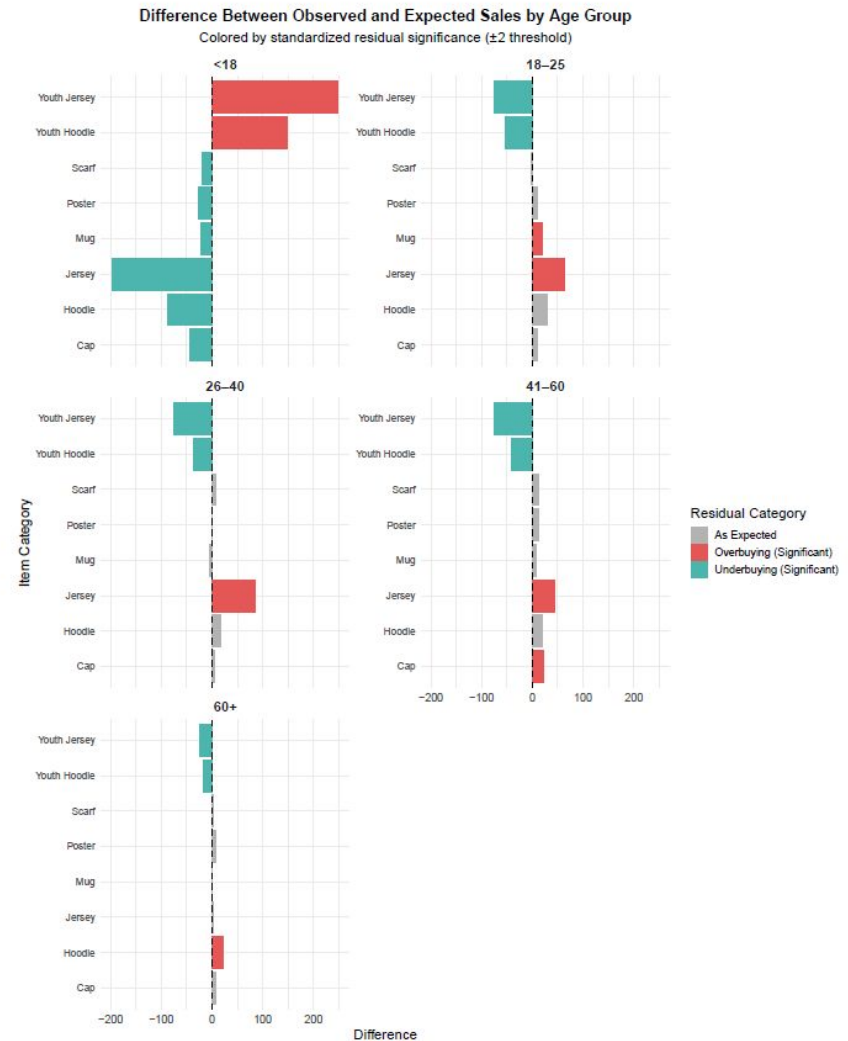
- Suggests a need for more tailored marketing/designs
- Signals the need for youth-focused products like water bottles, mascot plushies, etc.

18 - 60

- Underbuying youth items despite most likely having children. Create family bundles, support gifting services (blind boxes, gift wrapping, etc.)

60+

- Buying behaviour is mostly expected



New Promotion Strategies

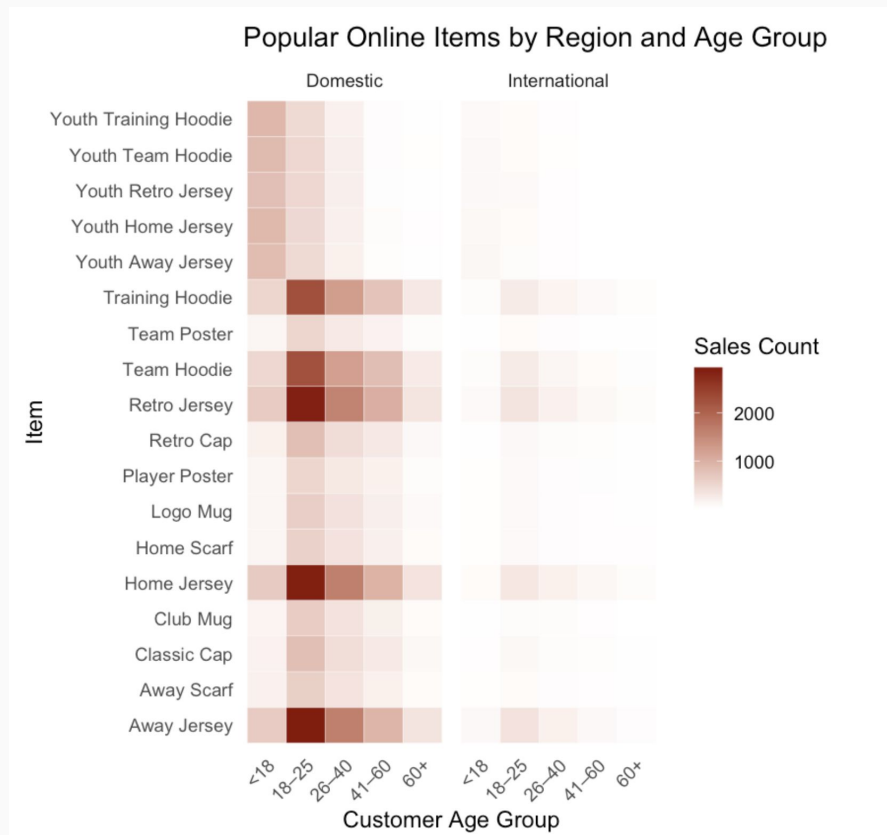
Season	Age group	Item focus	Strategies	Reasoning
Pre-season (Jan - Feb)	<18 , 18-25	Youth Jerseys, Youth Hoodies, Jerseys	Pre-order. Early bird promotion.	Young consumers, or students, are most responsive in pre-season.
Peak Season (Mar - Jun)	18-25, 26-40	Jerseys, Hoodies	Flash sales focused on Game Day. Combo bundles.	More emotional identity driven purchases when peak. Wear loyalty items (visible, shareable, social).
Mid Season Drop (Jul - Sep)	26-40, 41-60	Mugs, Hoodies, Family Bundles. Multiple family members can buy or give products at discount.	Fan appreciation. “Thank you” summer sales. Clearance sales.	Sales are decreasing and slowing down.
Late Season & Holiday (Sept - Dec)	All ages	Gift Bundles (Hoodie+Mug + Scarf)	Holiday fan bundles. Festive bundles.	Holiday gifting period. Family members buy gifts for seniors, kids, grandchildren.

Mid-Season Merchandise Drops

Introduce new jerseys, hoodies and caps mid-season.



Sustain domestic and international sales momentum beyond early-season sales peak.



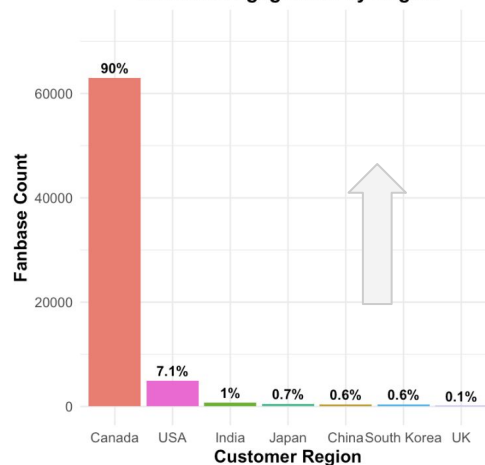
Mid-Season Merchandise Drops

Design culturally inspired merchandise, collaborating with local artists, that celebrates Vancouver's growing multicultural population and the team's international fanbase using sustainable production practices



Deepen resonance with the domestic community and attract international fans.

Fanbase Engagement by Region



“Fans increasingly seek authentic and sustainable products that reflect their values and enhance their connection to the sport.”
(Statista, 2025)

Merchandise Sales by Region



“Soccer communities seek products that resonate with their heritage, leading to a demand for culturally inspired merchandise.”
(Statista, 2025)

Mid-Season Merchandise Drops

Market merchandise through social media (Tik-Tok and Instagram) as symbols of belonging to increase community engagement.



Use merchandise to create international fan loyalty and cultural connection, aligning with BOLT'S mission of unity through football.

“The club is a hub for neighborhoods, cultures, and campuses; everyone should feel at home in Vancouver City FC colors.”

Risk Assessment

Risk	Rationale	Mitigation
Promotions shrink margins	Discount-driven promotions increase the number of sales but reduce profit earned per item.	Use diverse promotion types like bundles (increase average purchase size) and balance them with new product launches.
Uncertain Demand for New Products	Fans may respond differently to new product lines or pricing. International fanbase is only 10%.	Start with small scale product launches in top performing regions (Canada, USA and India) and collect feedback to refine future merchandise drops.
Cultural or branding misalignment	Culturally inspired collections risk being perceived as inauthentic.	Collaborate with local artists and fan clubs to design merchandise, ensuring authenticity and meeting Vancouver City FC's value of unity and belonging.

KPIs:

- Chi-square test of Independence per age group and product category.
- Advertising engagement
- Merchandise MRR

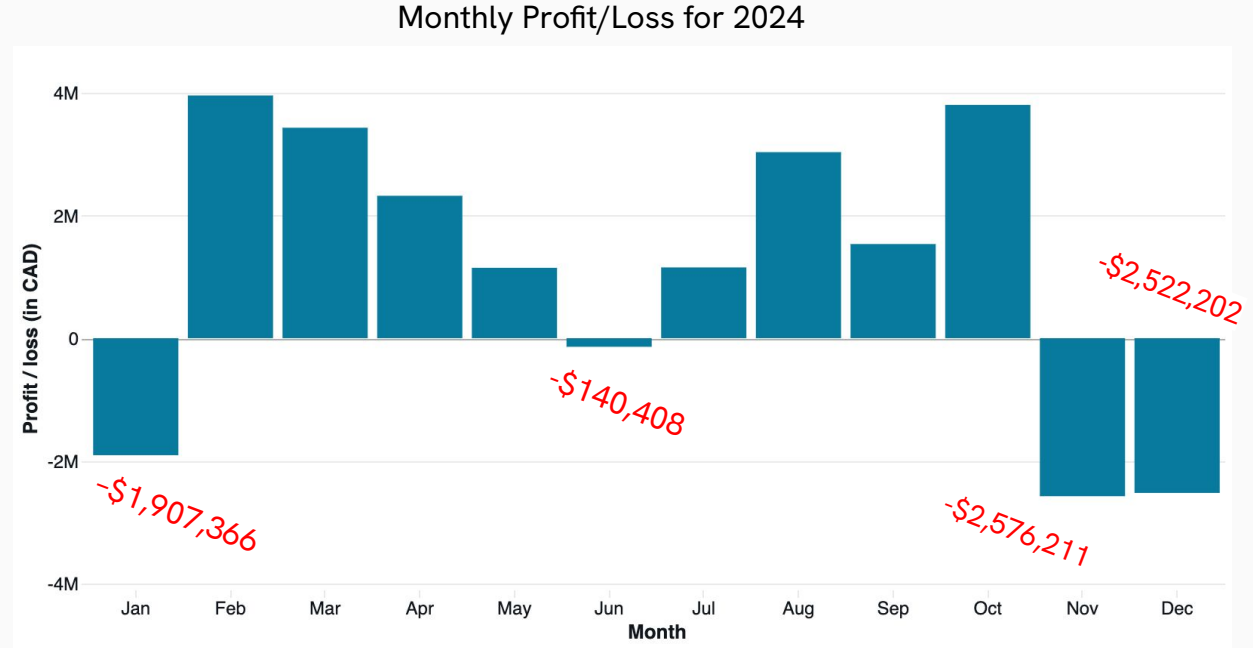
Outcome:

- Strengthen local and international football community through merchandise.
- Revenue growth through promotions and new product sales.

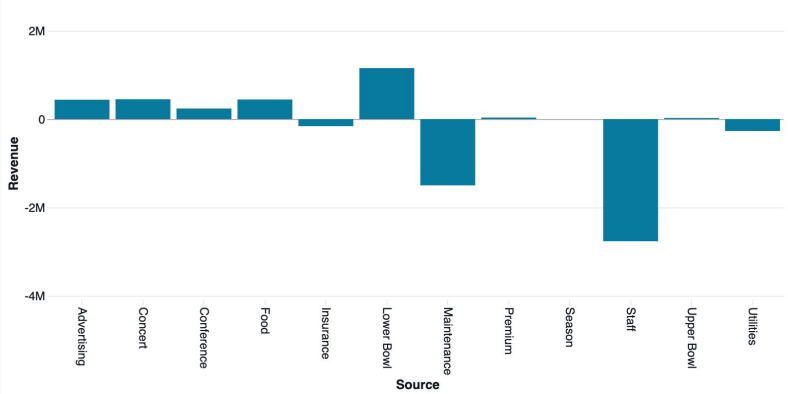
Issue 3: Operational Inefficiencies

Stadium operations profit is inconsistent and incur significant losses especially during off-season months.

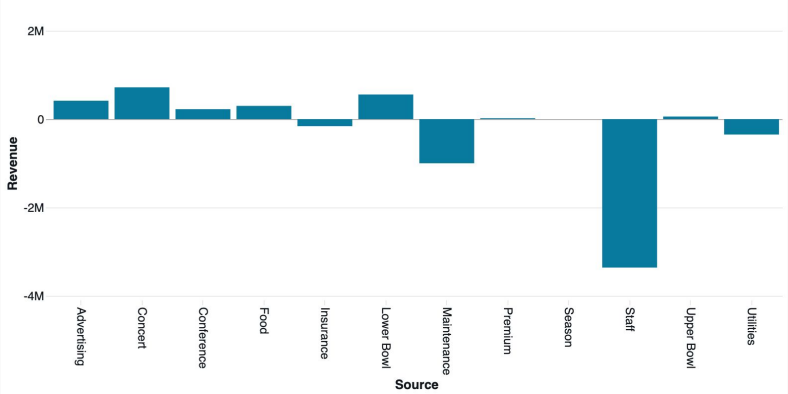
Losses are exacerbated by seasonal demand for merchandise.



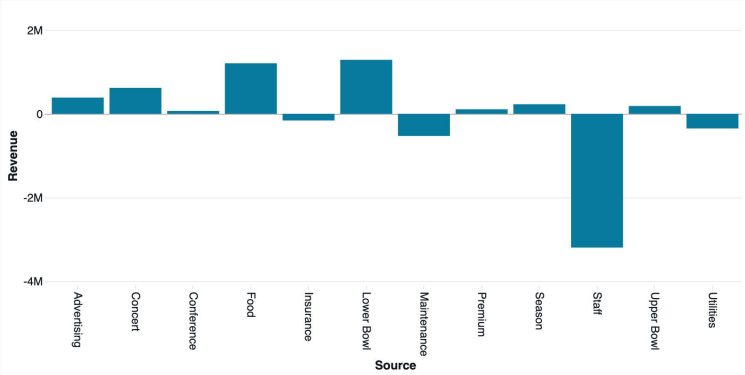
January



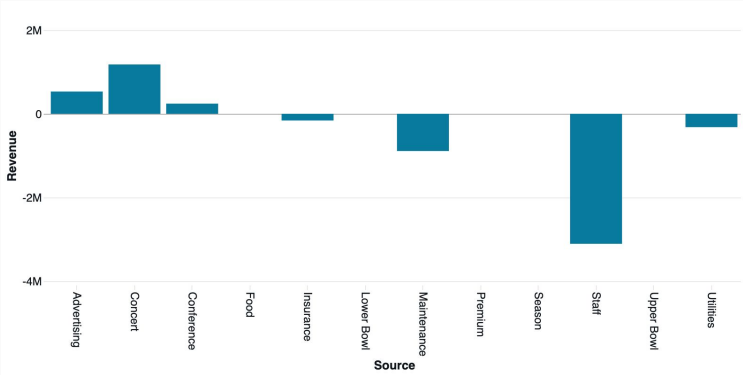
November



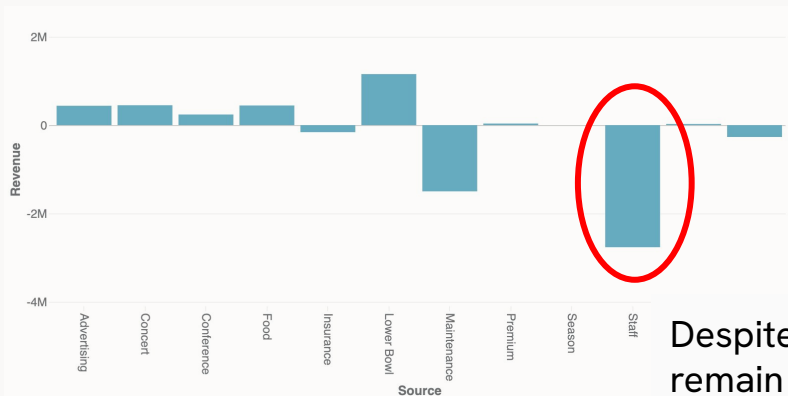
June



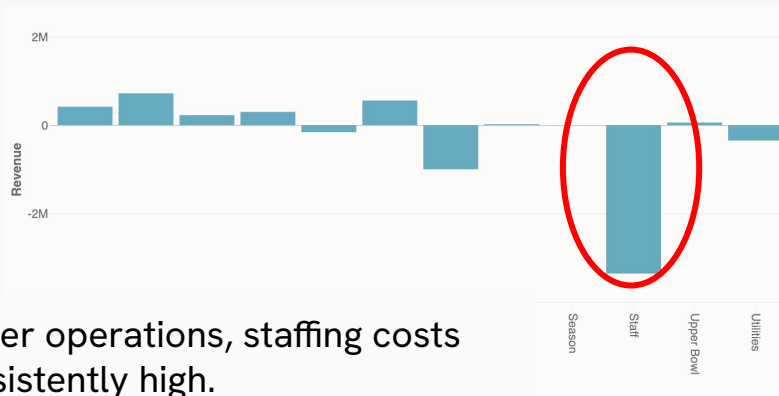
December



January



November



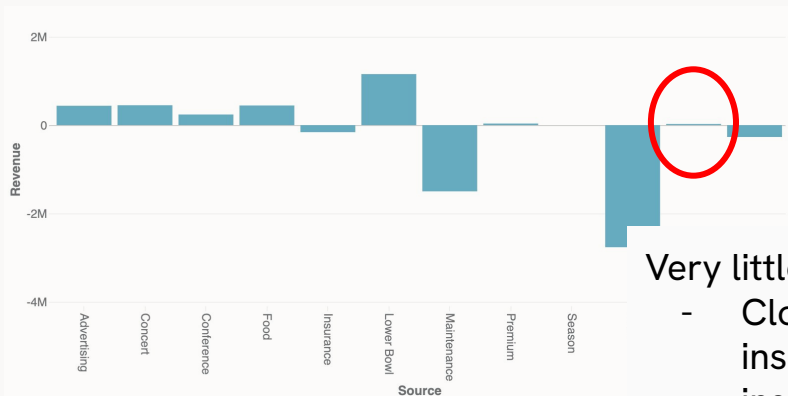
Despite lower operations, staffing costs remain consistently high.

- Reducing staff during off-season may curb excessive costs.

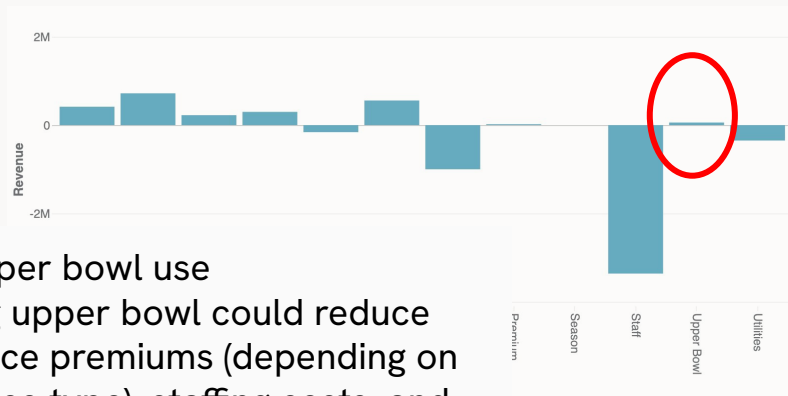
June



January



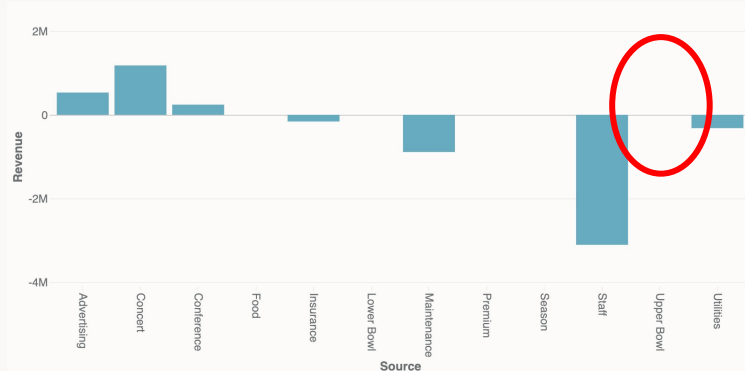
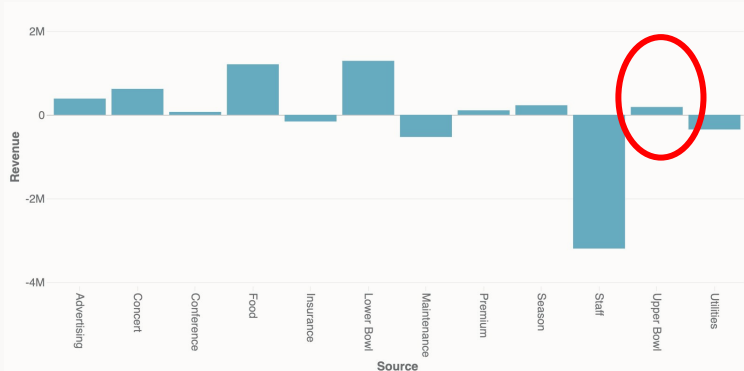
November

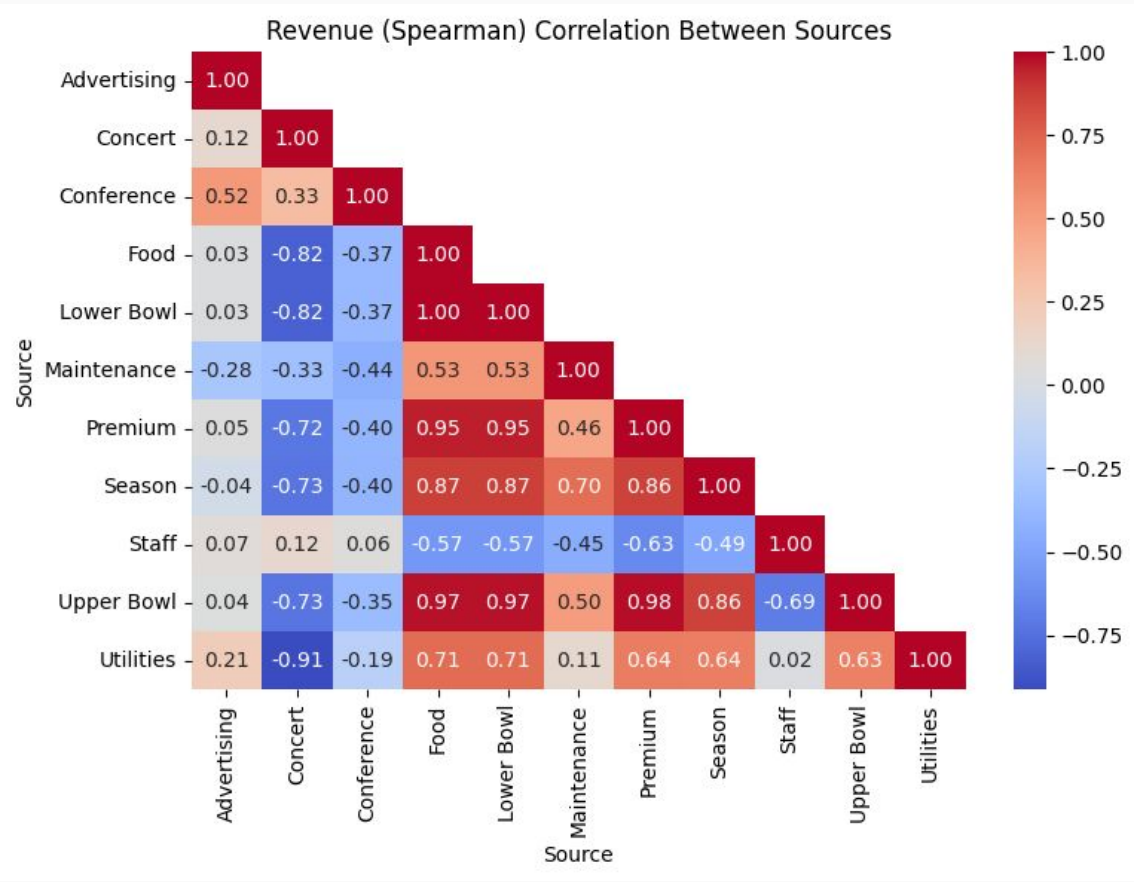


Very little upper bowl use

- Closing upper bowl could reduce insurance premiums (depending on insurance type), staffing costs, and utilities.

June



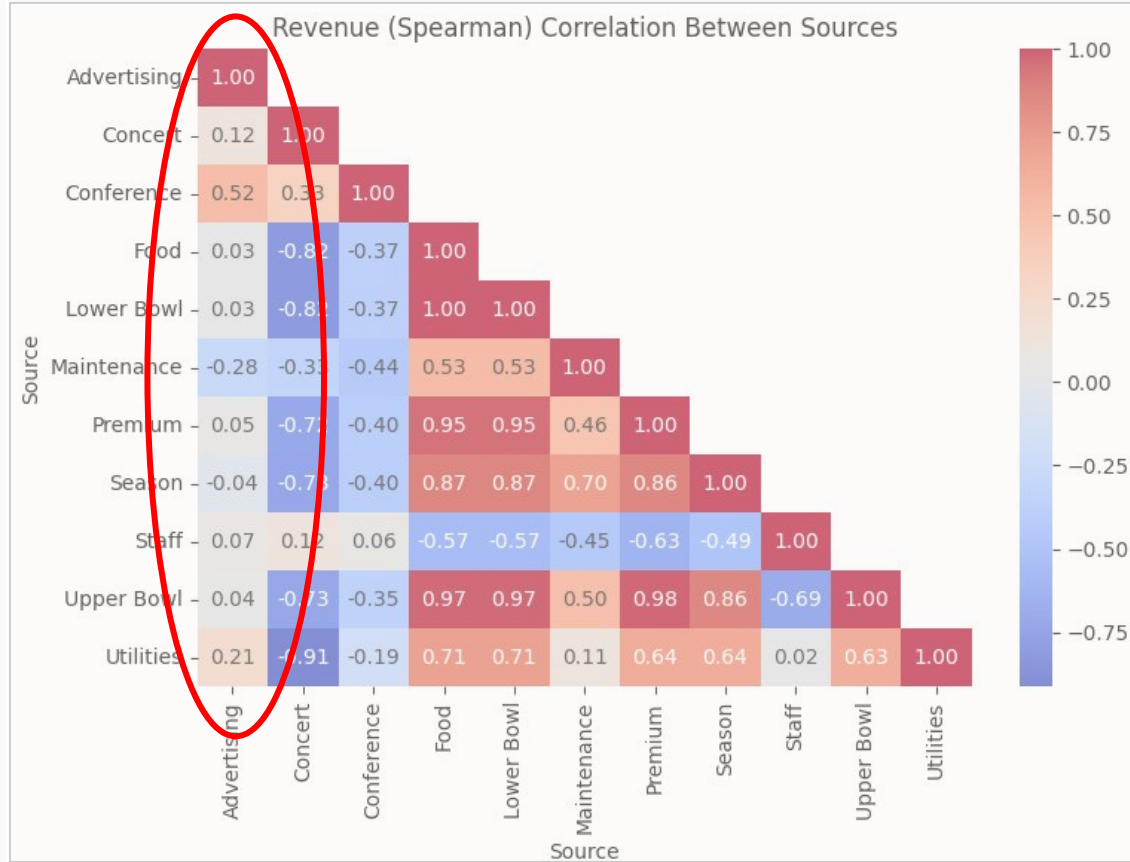


Insights:

Advertising remains an independent source of revenue which should be maximized year-round.

Concerts and conferences have a weak correlation with staffing. Prioritizing these events increase revenue while staffing costs remain the same.

Note: Concert correlation with utilities is strongly negative, suggesting more concerts reduce utilities costs. However this might be caused by some months having 0 concert revenue. Distorting results.

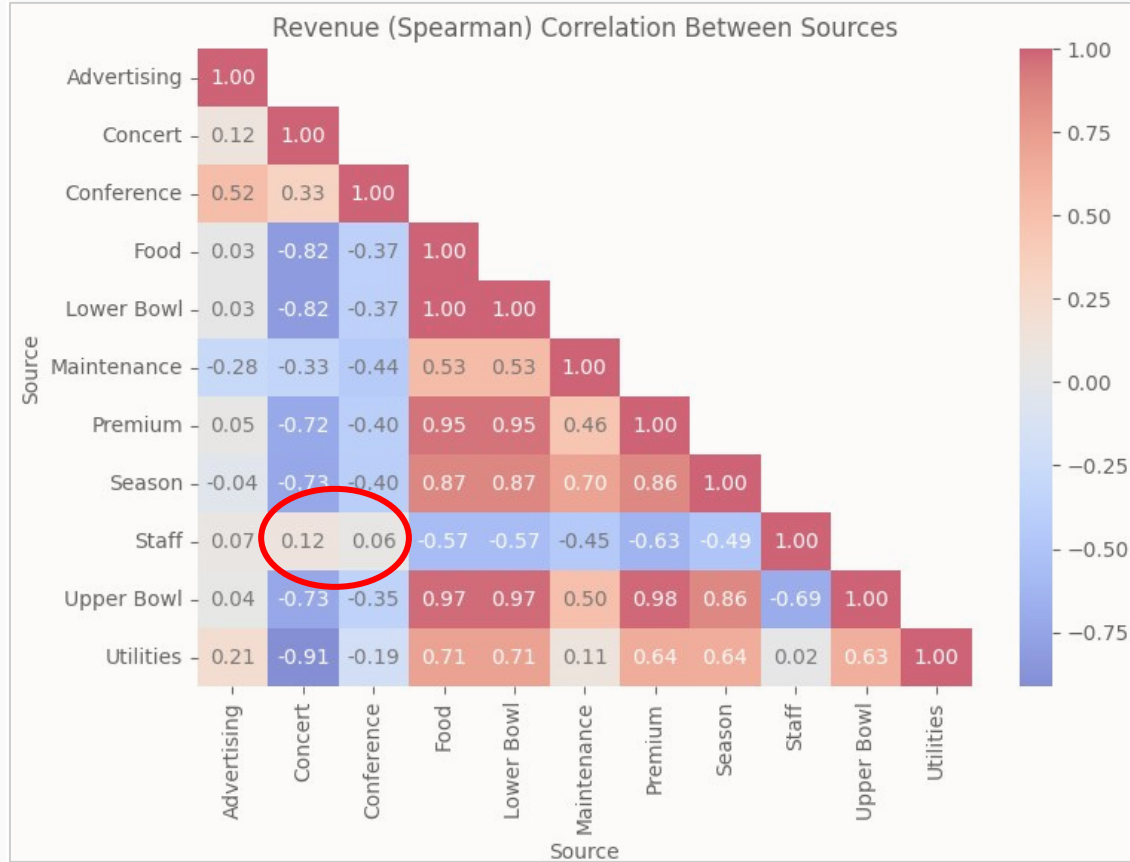


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Off-season Opportunities

Stadium Tours

Provide stadium tours for the general public.

- + Increase engagement
- + Attract International fans who are likely to spend more

Exhibition Matches

Host exhibition matches for bigger international teams.

- + International attention
- + Social media marketing opportunities

Soccer Lessons

Host paid soccer lessons and scout talent.

- + Youth development
- + Reputation

Non-league Friendly Matches

Host friendly matches against other teams.

- + Community development
- + Fanbase engagement

Risk Assessment

Risk	Rationale	Mitigation
Off-season opportunities are costly	Facilitating new off-season opportunities may require significant investment.	Research and survey the general public to optimize off-season usage. Keeping the community engaged, while exploring worthwhile investments.
Reducing staff hurts reputation	Instead of helping the community, some members of the community are worse off.	Shift to part-time/rotational schedules or prioritize volunteer work to keep the community engaged. Maintain transparency with the community.
Closing upper bowl reduces capacity	Reducing stadium capacity reduces revenue.	With less demand for tickets during the off-season, we can act accordingly by reducing the supply. This could reduce costs elsewhere like insurance and maintenance.

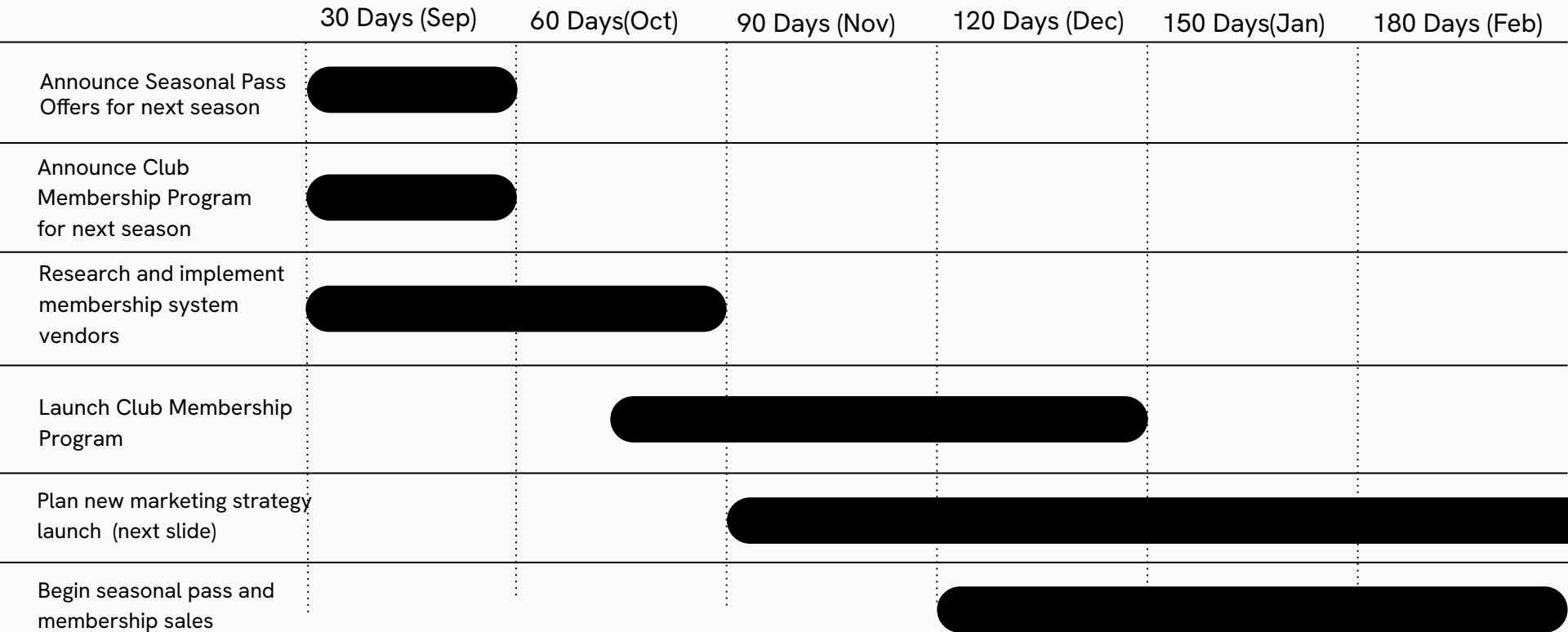
KPIs:

- Increased profit during off-season months
- Reduced costs year round

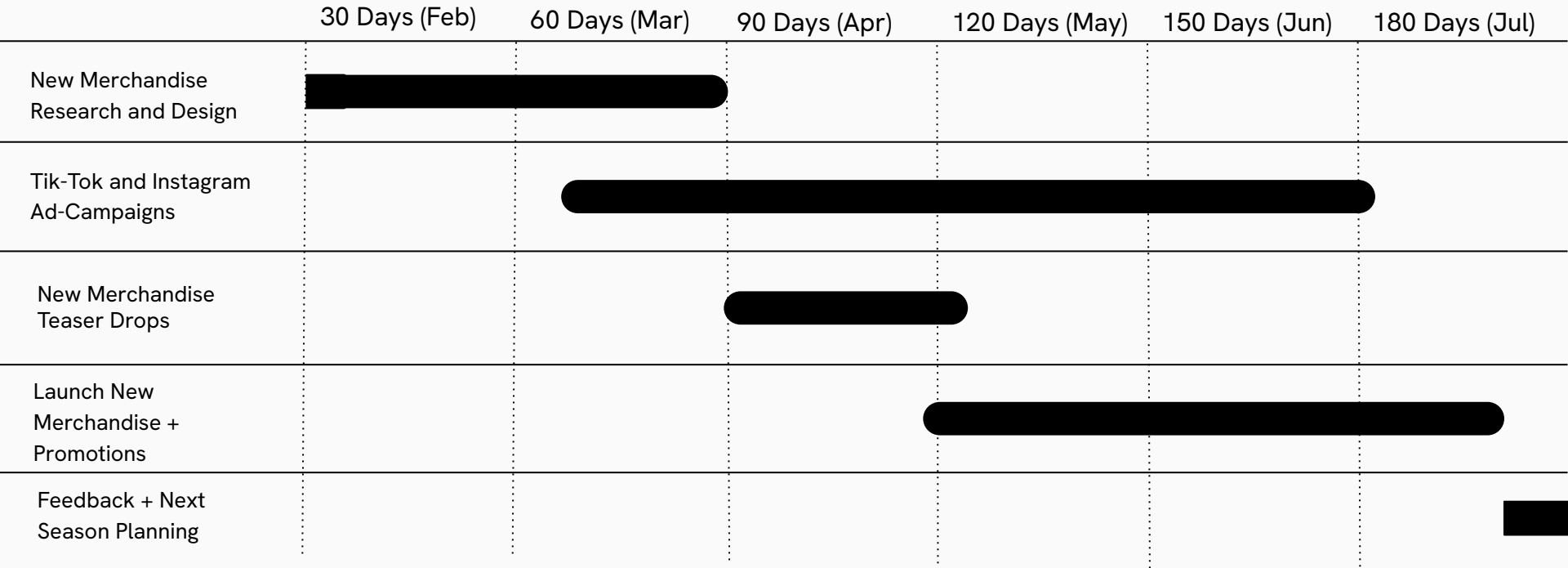
Outcome:

- Explore new revenue streams
- Optimized operating expenses

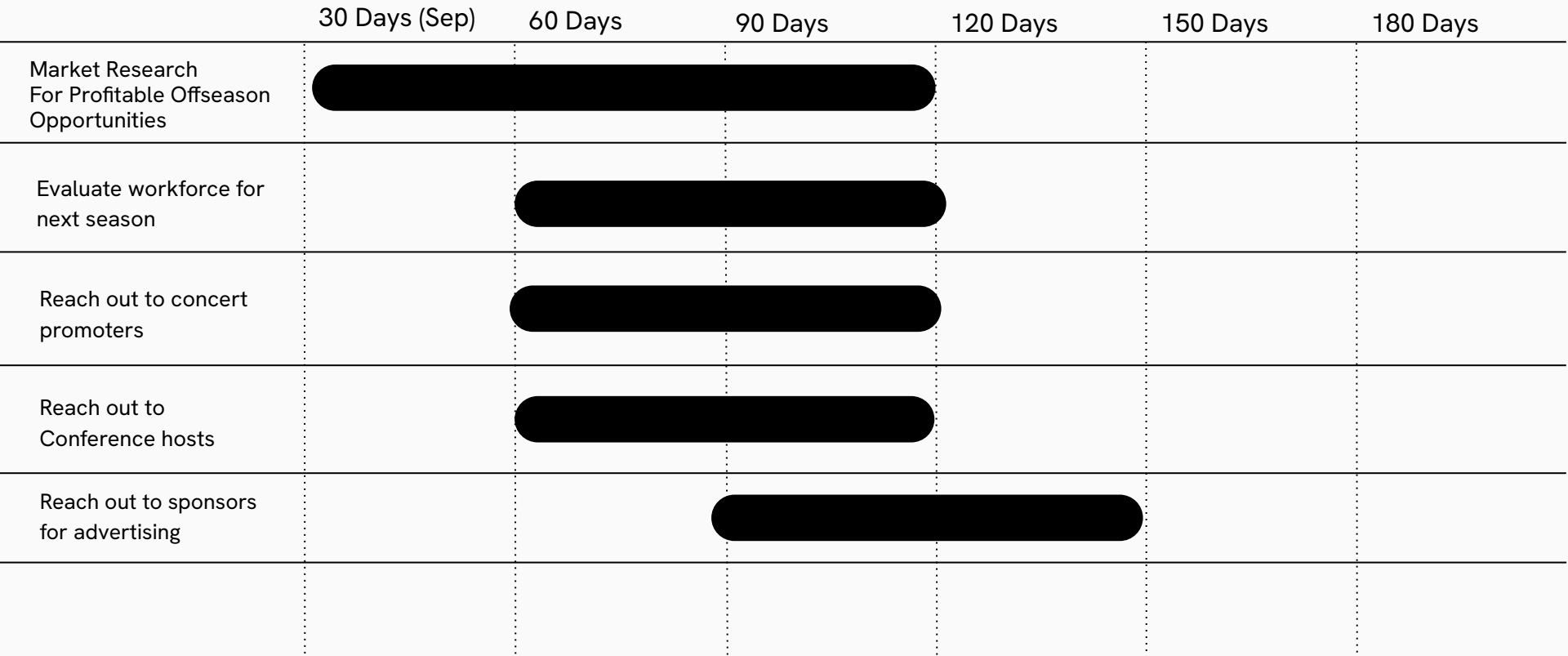
Recommendation 1: Gantt Chart



Recommendation 2: Gantt Chart



Recommendation 3: Gantt Chart



Conclusion

1

Loyalty Incentives

Revitalize the local fanbase to catalyze community growth.

- Club Membership Program.

- Tailored season pass offerings.

- Expand offers to international fans in the long-run.

2

Tailored Marketing

New marketing strategies.

- New merchandise and promotions.

- New marketing and product release strategy.

- Social Media for marketing and community engagement.

3

P&L Optimization

Maintain profits and reduce costs year-round.

- Reduce staffing costs during off season.

- Close upper bowl seats to reduce insurance premiums in off-season.

- Maximize and explore profitable off-season opportunities.

4

Evaluation

Analyze the strategies performance and impact

- Measure KPIs.

- Competitive Analyses.

- Feedback loops.

5

Future Initiatives

Leverage AI and expand digitally and internationally.

- Personalized merchandise recommendation systems.

- Develop strategic partnerships.

- Establish social media presence across platforms (Youtube Highlights).

Thank you

Sources

<https://www.seattletimes.com/sports/sounders/sounders-apologize-to-fans-after-issues-with-ticket-sales-for-season-opener/>

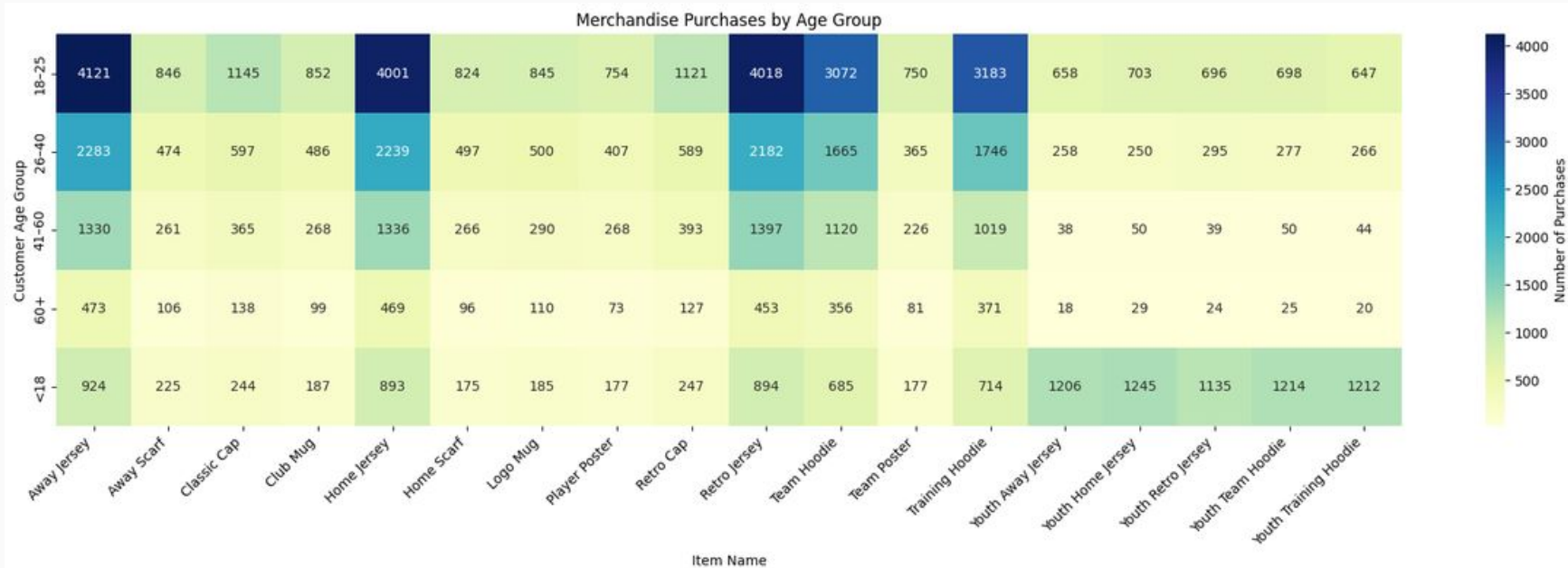
<https://www.latimes.com/sports/soccer/story/2021-04-07/season-ticket-holders-apply-lafc-galaxy-games>

<https://www.statista.com/outlook/amo/sports/soccer/soccer-merchandise/canada>

Appendix

UBC BOLT First Byte

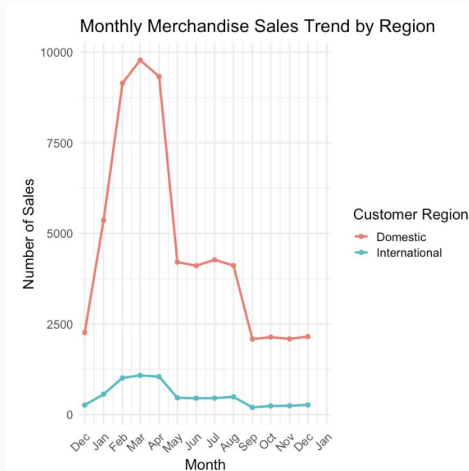
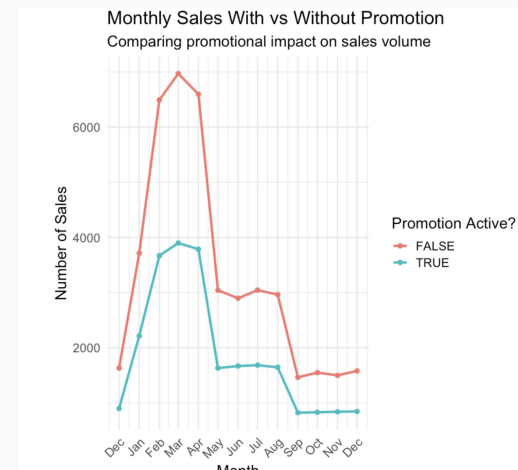
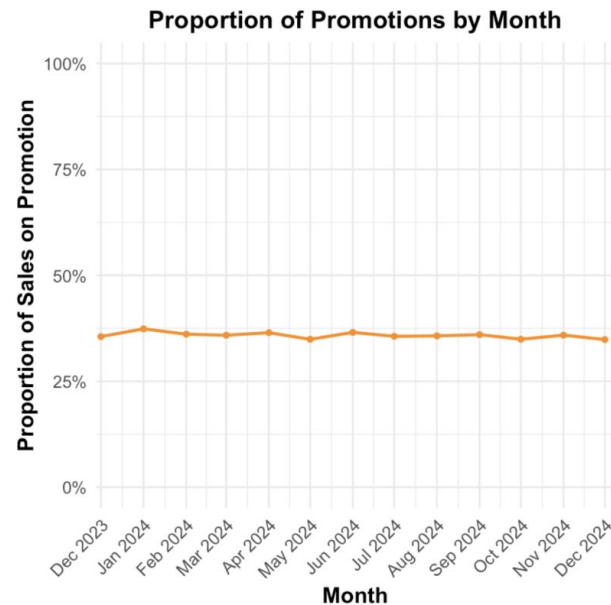
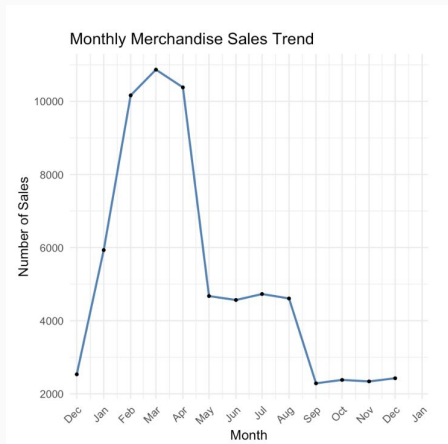
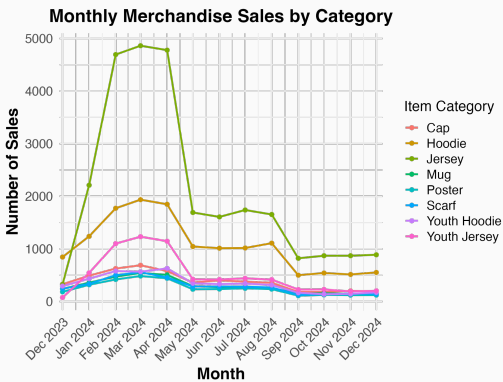
Useful visualizations and Insights



Appendix 1: Merchandise purchased by age group and item name

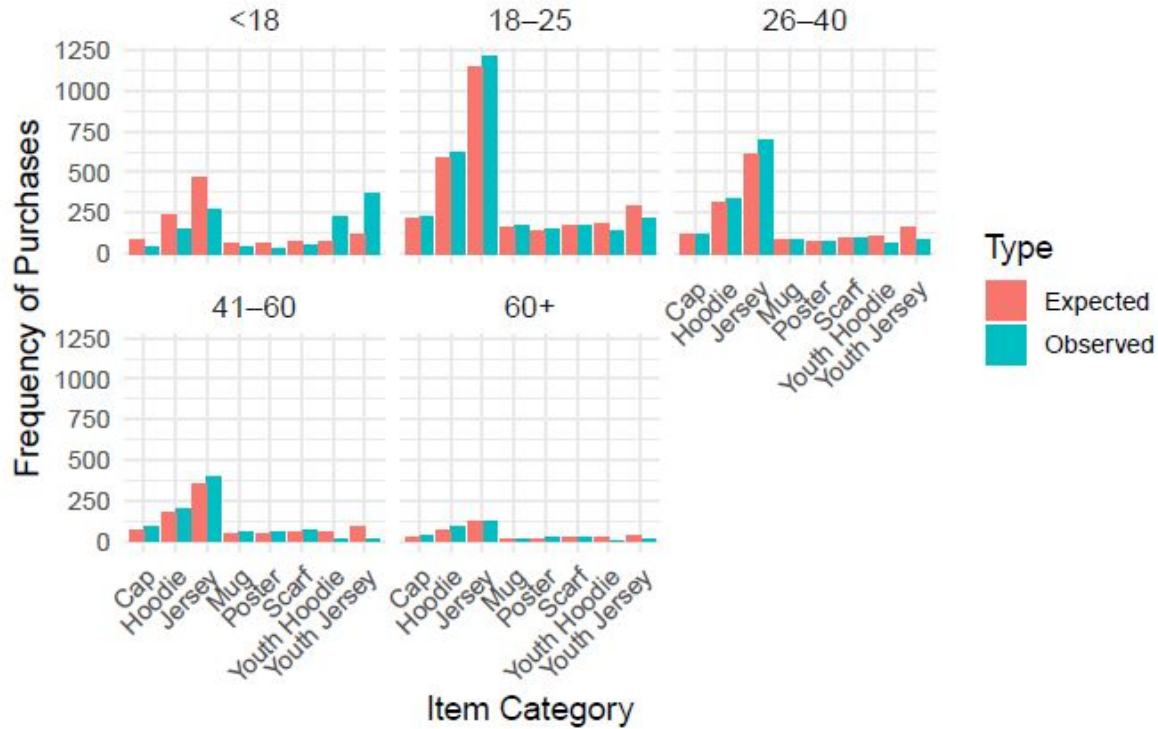


Appendix 2: Seasonal pass average games attended

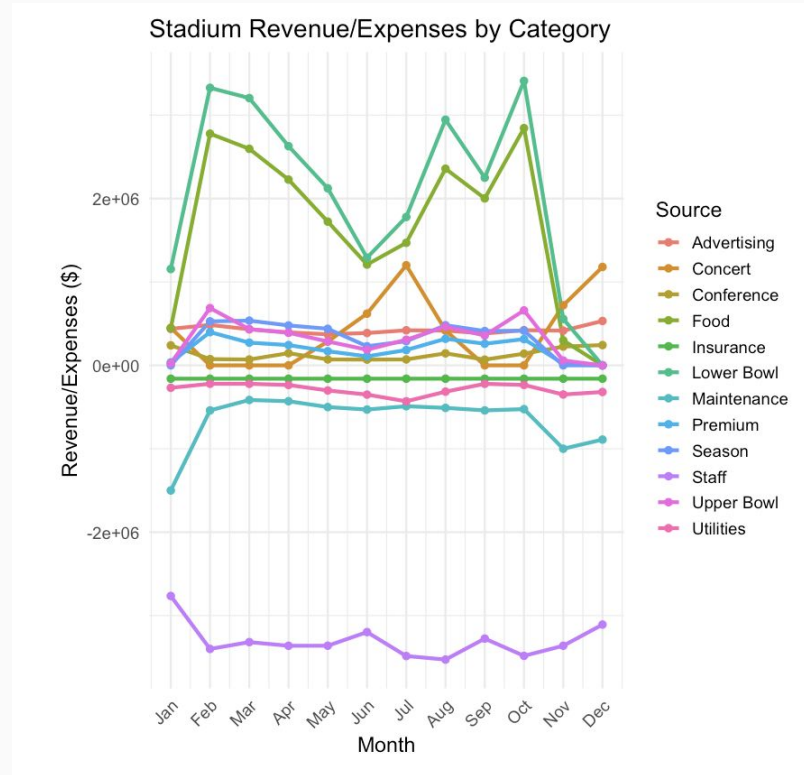


Appendix 3: Monthly sales trends

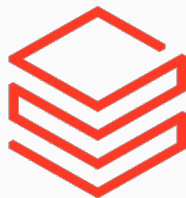
Observed vs Expected Sales by Age Group



Appendix 4: Expected and Observed frequency of sales amongst age groups and item category.



Appendix 5: Stadium operations revenue by source



databricks

